

I Meant to Do My Work Today

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Warm-up

There are times when we have work to do and yet, we feel like playing. What do you do during such times? Share your thoughts with your class. Listen carefully to your classmates' answers to find out how they complete their work on time.



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I meant to do my work today,
But a brown bird sang in the apple tree,
And a butterfly flitted across the field,
And all the leaves were calling me.
And the wind went sighing over the land,
Tossing the grasses to and fro,
And a rainbow held out its shining hand—
So what could I do but laugh and go?

flitted

flew away quickly

sighing

breathing out slowly and noisily

tossing

making something move from side to side or up and down

to and fro

in one direction and then another, a number of times

Understanding the Poem

(reading for main ideas)



A. Many things worked together to stop the poet from doing his work.

Complete the table to show what they were and what they did.

Work in pairs. Check your partner's answers and ask him/her to check yours.

Things	What they did
1. brown bird	a.
2.	b. flitted across the field
3. leaves	c.
4. wind	d.
5.	e. held out its shining hand



B. Answer these questions and check your answers.

1. What did the poet mean to do that day?
2. What stopped him from doing what he meant to do?
3. What did the poet eventually do?

C. Think and answer.

(reading for inference; HOTS)

1. Is the poem about a child or an adult? Give reasons for your answer.
2. *And all the leaves were calling me.* What do you think they might have been saying?
3. Give another title to this poem.

D. Discuss in class.

(value-based question)

If you were the poet, would you have done your work or would you have gone outside? Why?



Appreciation

- A. Pick out the pairs of **rhyming words** from the poem. Show your answers to your teacher to find out if they are correct.
- B. Why are rhyming words used in poems? Find out with the help of your teacher. **2T** **DC**
- C. Note how the leaves, the wind and the rainbow are described as if they are people doing actions. This is known as **personification**. What effect does this technique create? Discuss in groups of four. Share your answer with your teacher. **TC** **CT**



Life Skills Activity

(critical thinking; coping with stress)

Have you ever made excuses for not doing something important? It might have been because you were trying to do too many things at the same time. A 'to-do' list will be helpful in such a situation.

In a list like this, write the things that you need to do. Then, once you finish it, mark each task as 'done'. Which task did you find the most difficult to complete and why? Share your answer with the class. **CT** **com** **2T** **ED**

